

"MARE HUE KO KYA MAARNA (WHY KILL THE DEAD)?"



AFP PHOTO/PRAKASH SINGH

Mayawati

That was Mayawati taking a dig at Mulayam Singh after her return to the throne of the country's largest state. Call it social engineering or caste politics, but when the self-proclaimed champion of the Dalits won back Uttar Pradesh, she also found allies among the upper castes, who form 30 per cent of the state's electorate. Even a vigorous campaign led by the rockstar-like Congress heir apparent Rahul Gandhi and a Mulayam-Amar-Amitabh joint effort couldn't save the day, as Mighty Maya triumphed in a landslide victory, winning 206 of the 402 Assembly seats. In the 2002 elections, the BSP had won just 98 seats.

- Cannes celebrated 60 years of its existence.
- British Prime Minister Tony Blair announced his retirement in a year.
- Nicolas Sarkozy was elected President of France, defeating Ségolène Royal.
- Pakistan coach Bob Woolmer (below) died

MIKE HUTCHINGS / REUTERS



under mysterious circumstances during the cricket World Cup.

- A state of Emergency was declared in Bangladesh by Iajuddin Ahmed.

RAHUL GANDHI during the run-up to the Uttar Pradesh Assembly polls

"Once my family decides on something, it doesn't go back. Whether it's about India's freedom or dividing Pakistan."

Happily Ever After

An eager nation found itself waiting at the pearly gates of Bollywood's most powerful family, as eligible bachelor Abhishek Bachchan tied the knot with India's international face Aishwarya Rai. It might have been a private ceremony, but with pictures splashed all over the newspapers, it became the most public.



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major terrorist blasts hit the country this year so far—that on the Samjhauta Express in February, and in Gorakhpur and Hyderabad in May.

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